Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Sunday, 25 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Light drizzle	Drizzle	Rain
13° 9°	12° 8°	12° 9°	10° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The UK is set to invest £100 million in a new 'world first' AI Biosecurity Lab, as part of the Chancellor's upcoming Budget.**

This significant spending is aimed at bolstering the UK's defences against potential threats posed by artificial intelligence. The announcement will be made in Wednesday's Budget.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

2 **A Tory activist at the centre of 'contract killing broker' claims had previously worked for the party's headquarters.**

Jack Ross was reportedly contracted to handle social media work for the Conservative Party until earlier this year. The BBC has been told about his previous involvement.

POLITICS · UK

3 **A detective who was raped by a colleague has spoken out, saying she believes Met chief Sir Mark Rowley is 'not fit for the job'.**

Detective Constable Linda Williams, a victim of serial abuser David Carrick, expressed her complete lack of faith in the current system. Her comments highlight ongoing concerns about police integrity.

CRIME · UK

4 **Brace yourselves, as the UK prepares for the worst of Storm Boelo, with amber warnings set to come into force.**

Scotland, parts of northern England and Northern Ireland are expected to be hit by the strongest winds. This is the second storm to affect the country in as many days.

WEATHER · UK

5 **A plan for a Northern Olympics is set to receive £7 million in the Chancellor's Budget, for a full feasibility study.**

The funding will explore in detail how hosting the Olympic Games in northern England could work. It's an exciting prospect for the region.

OLYMPICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Reports suggest the final screen tests for the next James Bond are happening this weekend, with two British actors 'in the mix'.**

Callum Turner and Jack Lowden are reportedly among those being considered for the iconic role. Fans are eagerly awaiting news on who will take over as 007.

ON AIR — Who do you think would make the best new James Bond?

FILM · COMING UP

2 **Irish DJ Jazzy is set to drop her debut album soon, following a staggering billion streams online.**

Having emerged from the Dublin club scene, Jazzy has already collaborated with major industry names like Calvin Harris. Her new album is highly anticipated.

ON AIR — Which new artists are you excited about hearing more from?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **TV stars Keith Brymer Jones and Marj Hogarth are planning a unique wedding in their chapel home in May 2027.**

The couple, known for their TV appearances, got engaged on 'Welsh soil'. Their chapel home in Pwllheli will be the picturesque setting for their big day.

ON AIR — What's the most unusual wedding venue you've ever heard of?

TV · FUTURE

4 **The new presenters of Strictly Come Dancing, Josh Widdicombe, Emma Willis and Johannes Radebe, are reportedly 'getting into the groove'.**

While their initial reviews were a bit frosty, critics now suggest the trio are settling into their roles. It seems they're winning over viewers as the series progresses.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite Strictly Come Dancing presenter, past or present?

TV · NOW

5 **The Celebrity Traitors was left on a knife edge after a dramatic trip to the 'field of screams' in Friday's episode.**

A newly earned special power meant one contestant faced a huge decision. It sounds like the tension is really building in the castle!

ON AIR — Are you hooked on The Traitors? Who do you think is playing the best game?

TV · NOW

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03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Nicolas Jackson has made an excellent start to his Aston Villa career, scoring a match-winning double against Manchester City.**

The former Chelsea player is being hailed as an 'upgrade' on Watkins after his impressive performance. It's a huge result for Villa against the champions.

ON AIR — Aston Villa are looking strong this season – how far do you think they can go?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Arsenal have relieved some pressure in the Women's Super League with a crucial win against rivals Tottenham.**

This victory ends their five-match winless run in the league. The question now is whether they can use this momentum to kick on.

ON AIR — Do you think this win will be a turning point for Arsenal's WSL season?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England's Men's Rugby League team needs a few things to go their way next weekend to avoid a World Cup exit.**

After a 68-point swing and a Tonga win, England have at least given themselves a chance. It's going to be a nail-biting finish to the group stage.

ON AIR — How confident are you that England can make it through to the next round of the Rugby League World Cup?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4 **Boxing fans are eagerly awaiting predictions for Saturday's light-welterweight world title fight between Dalton Smith and Alberto Puello.**

Figures from the boxing world are weighing in on who they think will emerge victorious. It promises to be an exciting night for British boxing.

ON AIR — Who are you backing in the Smith vs Puello world title fight?

BOXING · UK

5 **Britain's Jake Jarman has won a historic fourth World Artistic Gymnastics Championships medal, with floor silver in Rotterdam.**

This incredible achievement marks another significant milestone in Jarman's career. He continues to impress on the world stage.

ON AIR — Jake Jarman is making history – what's been your favourite British gymnastics moment?

GYMNASTICS · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new study suggests that the sound of a distant ice cream van can trigger feelings of nostalgic joy in adults more strongly than anticipated.**
Researchers found that the familiar jingle often brings back vivid childhood memories, providing a surprising mental uplift for many. It seems some sounds are truly timeless!

2 **The humble act of 'perfectly zesting a lemon' is becoming a small, satisfying ritual for home cooks.**
It's not just about the flavour; the fine texture and bright aroma released are providing a moment of calm and focus in busy kitchens.

3 **Experts are noticing a growing appreciation for the unique patterns formed by 'rain on a window pane'.**
Far from being a sign of gloomy weather, many are finding beauty in the natural artistry of raindrops creating intricate, fleeting designs.

4 **The gentle hum of a refrigerator is, for some, a surprisingly comforting background noise.**
It's been described as a subtle, constant presence that signifies a working home, offering a quiet, almost meditative, ambience.

5 **More people are finding delight in the moment a 'teacup clinks perfectly onto its saucer'.**
This small, everyday sound, often overlooked, is being celebrated as a tiny, satisfying punctuation mark in the ritual of making a brew.

6 **A trend for 'mindful unpacking' after a shopping trip is gaining traction, focusing on appreciating each item.**
Instead of rushing, people are taking their time, noticing textures, colours, and even the simple act of putting things away neatly, turning a chore into a calm experience.

7 **The distinct aroma of 'freshly cut grass' is being hailed as one of the most evocative scents of British summer, even on cooler days.**
It's a scent that instantly transports many to sunny garden memories, offering a fleeting reminder of warmer times.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of biscuit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE TAP OR 'THUMP' AGAINST THE TABLE TO ASSESS ITS CRISPNESS OR STURDINESS.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of marmalade, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A VERY DEEP, SLOW SNIFF DIRECTLY FROM THE JAR BEFORE THE FIRST SPOON GOES IN.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' in your local area – perhaps a quiet bench with a view, a particularly colourful flowerbed, or a charming little shop you hadn't noticed before?**
  We'd love to hear about the delightful little discoveries you've made right on your doorstep. What's a local secret you're happy to share?

- **We all have that 'one particular piece of clothing' that, no matter what, just makes us feel instantly good, don't we? It might be old, comfortable, or just have a happy memory attached.**
  What's that special item of clothing in your wardrobe that always brings a smile to your face, and why does it mean so much to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the modern concept of a 'sandwich' is said to have originated in 18th-century England, named after John Montagu, the 4th Earl of Sandwich, who asked for meat to be served between slices of bread so he could eat without interrupting his card game?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public park in the world was created in ancient Rome, featuring elaborate fountains and exotic animals for the entertainment of its citizens.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£66 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£66 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death by burning down the rat-infested houses.
- Mount Everest grows by approximately 4 millimetres each year due to geological uplift.
- There are more than 10,000 different varieties of tomatoes worldwide.
- The first message sent by Morse code was 'What hath God wrought?' in 1844.
- The 'Queen's official birthday' in the UK is celebrated on the second Saturday of June, regardless of her actual birth date.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SUN 25 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 298 of the year, 67 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Romania); Christian feast day: Bernat Calbó (Bernard of Calvo); Christian feast day: Canna; Christian feast day: Blessed Carlo Gnocchi. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1988 — Lewis McGugan, English professional footballer
- 1944 — Jon Anderson, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1970 — Adam Pascal, American actor and singer
- 1993 — Rachel Matthews, American actress
- 1984 — Katy Perry, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1979 — Rob Hulse, English footballer
- 1946 — Peter Lieberson, American composer (died 2011)
- 1945 — Phil Volk, American musician, singer-songwriter, and record producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1980 — Proceedings on the Hague Convention on the Civil Aspects of International Child Abduction conclude.
- 1940 — Benjamin O. Davis Sr. is named the first African American general in the United States Army.
- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis: Adlai Stevenson shows the United Nations Security Council reconnaissance photographs of Soviet ballistic missiles in Cuba.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — A Learjet 35 crashes in Mina near Aberdeen, South Dakota, killing all six people on board, including PGA golfer Payne Stewart and golf course designer Bruce Borland.
- 1944 — World War II: The final attempt of the Imperial Japanese Navy to win the war climaxes at the Battle of Leyte Gulf.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1968 — Soyuz 2 is launched.
- 1980 — Proceedings on the Hague Convention on the Civil Aspects of International Child Abduction conclude.

- 1983 — The United States and its Caribbean allies invade Grenada, six days after Prime Minister Maurice Bishop and several of his supporters are executed in a coup d'état.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES MON 26 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 299 of the year, 66 days left in 2026. Today Accession Day (Jammu and Kashmir, India); Angam Day (Nauru); Armed Forces Day (Benin); Christian feast day: Alfred the Great (Catholic Church, Anglican Church, Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Adam Mars-Jones, English author and critic
- 1973 — Austin Healey, English rugby player and sportscaster
- 1997 — Rhenzy Feliz, American actor and singer
- 1980 — Claire Cooper, English actress
- 1967 — Keith Urban, Australian-American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1984 — Amanda Overmyer, American singer-songwriter
- 1946 — Holly Woodlawn, Puerto Rican actress and author (died 2015)
- 1982 — Nicola Adams, English boxer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1944 — World War II: The Battle of Leyte Gulf ends with an overwhelming American victory.
- 1958 — Pan American Airways makes the first commercial flight of the Boeing 707 from New York City to Paris.
- 2015 — A 7.5 magnitude earthquake strikes in the Hindu Kush mountain range in South Asia, killing 399 people and leaving 2,536 people injured.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2002 — Approximately 50 Chechen terrorists and 150 hostages die when Russian special forces troops storm a theater building in Moscow, which had been occupied by the terrorists during a musical performance three days before.
- 2004 — Rockstar Games releases Grand Theft Auto: San Andreas for the PlayStation 2 in North America, which sold 12 million units for the PS2, becoming the console's best-selling video game.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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